

Shakespeare





About the Course

As foundational and influential English texts, students read three Shakespeare plays per year - usually a tragedy, a comedy, and a history (occasionally also connected to the historical time period). This year's plays are *The Tempest*, *Henry IV Part 2*, and *The Winter's Tale*.

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

Most Shakespeare lessons are shared with Grades 5-12. Students new to Shakespeare may choose to start with the Shakespeare Beginner Track lessons for two terms to ease into the plays.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-8	Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 1 time/week 30 min	<i>The Tempest</i> <i>The Tempest</i> (Audio recording) <i>Henry IV Part 2</i> <i>Henry IV Part 2</i> (Audio recording) <i>The Winter's Tale</i> <i>The Winter's Tale</i> (Audio recording)

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Shakespeare: Grades 5-8				
	Shakespeare: Grades 5-8			



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book *Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts* by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

- ∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
- ∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8



The Tempest Painted Puppets



The Tempest Black & White Puppets



Henry IV Part 2 Painted Puppets



Henry IV Part 2 Black & White Puppets



The Winter's Tale Painted Puppets



The Winter's Tale Black & White Puppets



Quick Links

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

- ∞ [Relational Methods, Sec. 9: How to Teach Shakespeare](#)
- ∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students start reading independently (General Literature selections are especially good for independent work).



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them an illustration, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Tempest

PREP: Read an overview of the play (one synopsis is located at the beginning of the Folger edition of the play). If you are not familiar with the play, you will want to read other retellings. We highly suggest Stories from Shakespeare by Marchette Chute. Resources are listed on the Extra Helpings Page. Also, be sure to read the note about mature content and language in Shakespeare in the Planning and Prep section.

→ INTRO

The Tempest is not a traditional tragedy or comedy. It is often called a Tragicomedy because it has both comedic and tragic elements. Overall, the play has a happy ending which places it in the comedic category. The name of the play 'tempest,' means "a violent storm." At the beginning, there is a violent storm which destroys a ship. Take time to review the elements of tragedy and comedy in the Genres link.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ RATIONALE

This is a romantic comedy about an overthrown Duke and his daughter who are exiled on an island. The play addresses the themes of power, betrayal, magic, slavery, and the restoration of relationships.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 1-2 p.7-25 "Boatswain!" - "Approach, my Ariel. Come."

- How do each of the characters respond to the storm? What is the tone of this scene?

★ TEACHER TIP

Take turns reading the play aloud if using these lessons in a group.

We recommend reading the summaries of each scene to briefly preview content.

Movie Recommendations: The Tempest (2010) PG-13

∞ **Link:** Course Hero Series (Each Scene Explained)

∞ **Link:** Genres of Shakespeare: See Tragedy & Comedy

WEEK 2

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 2

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recall: how did Prospero and Miranda come to be on the island?

→ INTRO

The Tempest explores the theme of power, and we see this in Prospero's relationships. Watch a portion of Act 1, Scene 2, to learn more about Prospero's relationship to Ariel.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-39 "All hail, great master!" - "So, slave, hence."

- How would you describe Prospero's relationship between Caliban and Ariel?

• EXTRA HELPING

Work with the students to finish quotes 1-2 on the character quote assignment.

∞ **Link:** Character Quotes

WEEK 3

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Think back on what you learn about Ariel and Caliban through Prospero's conversations with and about them. What is your opinion of Prospero at this point?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.41-49 "Come unto these" - "Speak not for him."

- What does Ferdinand think of Miranda? How do you think this relationship will develop or change?

• EXTRA HELPING

Work with the students to finish quotes 3-4 on the character quote assignment.

∞ **Link:** Character Quotes

WEEK 4

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: The Tempest

→ INTRO

The setting of The Tempest is unique. The play takes place on a remote island (meaning no one lives there) with the exception of Caliban and Ariel. This island is in the Mediterranean Sea. However, there are two important Italian Kingdoms mentioned-- Naples and Milan. Prospero and Miranda as well as the characters who crashed on the Island are from these kingdoms. Let's review the map and the character list to learn about where the characters are from.

∞ Map Link: Mediterranean Sea

∞ Link: Tempest and Kingdoms

→ RECAP

- Why did Prospero create the storm and bring the ship to the island?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 1 p.53-65 "Beseech you, sir" - "Go sleep, and hear us."

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

- What does this scene show about the characters of Antonio and Sebastian? How does it compare to Alonso's behavior?

WEEK 5

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Unfold the reason for King Alonso's having sailed from Tunis. What does he think of ever setting out for Tunis in the first place?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 1 p.65-75 "What, all soon" - "to seek thy son."

- How would you describe Alonso and Antonio's relationship?

WEEK 6

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What does Antonio propose that Sebastian do? How is this proposal similar to Antonio's actions towards his brother, Prospero?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 2 p.77-87 "All the infections" - "Lead the way."

- What is loyalty? How does loyalty motivate characters?

• EXTRA HELPING

At this point, students should be noting that Caliban does not like his master, Prospero. In fact, Caliban has valid reasons to resent Prospero. In this activity, students will try to visualize Caliban's cave. Seeing from another characters' point of view helps students learn with their imagination.

∞ **Link:** Caliban Visual

WEEK 7

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Tempest

→ INTRO

Act 3, Scene 2 highlights a lot of the conflict in The Tempest. Caliban and Ariel both use deception for different purposes. The Tempest Reporter activity will help guide your reading of the scene. If time permits at the end, you will report on your findings.

∞ **Link:** Tempest Reporter

→ RECAP

Describe Trinculo's account of his meeting Caliban.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 1-2 p.91-109 "There be some" - "I'll follow, Stephano."

- Why do you think Caliban plots against his master?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students watch a portion of Act 3, Scene 2.

∞ **Video Link:** Act 3, Scene 2

WEEK 8

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

What plan does Caliban propose to Stephano?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 1 p.109-125 "By 'r lakin" - "All eyes. Be Silent."

- What is the purpose of the magical banquet? How do people respond to the banquet?

WEEK 9

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Tempest

→ RECAP

Recall the conversation Prospero has with Ferdinand about his daughter, Miranda. What is your opinion of him as a father?

→ INTRO

This scene has a famous monologue with the phrase, "Our revels now are ended." Let's take some time to watch the clip before reading the scene.

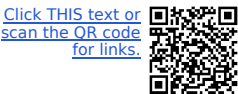
∞ **Video Link:** Act 4, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.125-141 "Ceres, most bounteous" - "do me service."

- Prospero deals with a lot of inner conflict (conflict within himself). How do we see Prospero resolving these inner conflicts?

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8



[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

Term 1		
WEEK 10	30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 10 Materials: The Tempest → RECAP Think back on what wishes Juno and Ceres bestow upon Ferdinand and Miranda at the masque. Reference Act 4 Scene 1 L119-130. What other blessings would you add if you were at their engagement party? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Act 5 Scene 1 p.145-157 "Now does my project" - "me my dukedom." • Why does Prospero choose to forgive his enemies instead of seeking revenge? What does this say about his character?	• EXTRA HELPING Have students watch a portion of Act 5, Scene 1. As students near the end of the play, have them consider concepts and characters. Use this fun, interactive activity from the Royal Shakespeare Company to get them thinking about these concepts. ∞ Video Link: Act 5, Scene 1 ∞ Link: Tempest Shapes
WEEK 11	30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 11 Materials: The Tempest → RECAP Recollect the scene in which Prospero draws a charmed circle with his staff. What does he say to those brought into the circle? → INTRO Many consider The Tempest Shakespeare's final work. Therefore, Prospero's farewell is often double-read as Shakespeare's farewell to the audience. Before reading the scene, watch Prospero's epilogue. If time permits, read the article on the epilogue at the end. ∞ Video Link: Prospero's Epilogue ∞ Article Link: Epilogue → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Act 5 Scene 1 p.157-171 "Sweet lord" - "indulgence set me free." → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS EPILOGUE p.169 & 171 • Why do you think Shakespeare chose to end the play with Prospero asking for the audience's "indulgence" (approval)?	• EXTRA HELPING The resolution of the Tempest is very complex. To help students connect the dots, have students play this review game. Students will be asked to fill in the quote, find answers, and escape the island! ∞ Link: Escape the Island Game
WEEK 12	30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Tempest	

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

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Term 2

WEEK 1

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 13

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ **RATIONALE: HENRY IV PART 2 IS A TALE ABOUT PRINCE HAL FALLING INTO HIS FATHER'S FOOTSTEPS AS KING. HAL'S LIFE WILL NO LONGER BE THE SAME WHEN HE FEELS THE WEIGHT OF THE CROWN.**

→ INTRO

Henry IV Part 2 is actually the third play in a tetralogy. The Henriad is all about Henry becoming the warrior king. Let's take time to review the first 6 slides on the Henriad plays to better understand the play.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Induction - Act 1 Scene 1 p.7-25 "Open your ears," - "yet more need."

- What role do you think Northumberland will play in this story?

★ TEACHER TIP

Pre-Teaching Materials:

Movies Recommendations:

The Hollow Crown Season 1, Episode 3. Rated TV-14 (please consult a parental guide before watching, consider skipping graphic scenes).

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself if desired on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his histories. Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

∞ **Link:** Genres of Shakespeare

WEEK 2

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 14

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

While Shakespeare's plays rooted in history, there are differences in the historical characters. Let's review the historical prince Henry slide together.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 2-3 p.27-49 "Sirrah, your giant," - "time bids begone."

- What is Falstaff's relationship with money and fame?

WEEK 3

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 15

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.53-75 "Master Fang," - "Follow me, Ned."

- If you were friends with Falstaff, what advice would you give him?

• EXTRA HELPING

Work with the student to translate Henry IV Part 2 Quotes.

∞ **Link:** Character Quotes

WEEK 4

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 3-4 p.77-95 "I pray thee," - "at your belly."

- What do you think is Northumberland's motive to join the rebellion?

• EXTRA HELPING

Work with the student to translate Henry IV Part 2 Quotes.

∞ **Link:** Character Quotes

WEEK 5

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Have you ever been given a responsibility that you didn't want? Or maybe the task you were given made you nervous? In the clip we're about to watch, we see how being a king is a big responsibility.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 4 - Act 3 Scene 1 p.95-115 "Have you turned" - "the Holy Land."

- How do we see the weight of the crown affecting King Henry?

WEEK 6

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 18

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Before reading the scene, let's watch a famous monologue from Falstaff called "The Chimes at Midnight." Keep in mind, Falstaff is about to lead a regiment into war.

∞ Video Link: The Chimes at Midnight

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• EXTRA HELPING

Work with the student to translate Henry IV Part 2 Quotes.

∞ **Link:** Character Quotes

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Act 3 Scene 2 p.117-137 "Come on, come on," - "there an end."

- What do you think the chimes of midnight mean?

WEEK 7

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 19

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 1 p.141-167 "What is this" - "yielder-up of breath."

- Who is John of Lancaster? What were some skills he demonstrated in the scene?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students draw two circles, have them label one "Sir John Falstaff," and the other "Prince Hal." From there list other characters who are related or have a significant relationship with those two characters.

WEEK 8

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 20

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

The real-life Henry IV had health problems that Shakespeare hints at in the play. Let's review slide 13 to see how the king's health decline plays a role in the story.

∞ Link: Henriad

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scenes 2-3 p.167-187 "What's your name," - "(Softly, pray.)"

- How has Hal and his father's relationship changed throughout the series? Do you think King Henry believes his son can be king?

WEEK 9

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 21

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

As we have seen, the relationship between Prince Hal and King Henry is complicated. In the clip we will watch, we will see how the crown complicates the relationship between the father and son.

∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 p.187-203 "Let there be" - "shall Harry die."

- Why is King Henry mad at Prince Hal?

WEEK 10

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 22

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ INTRO

Let's take a few minutes to recall key events. Create a list or a series of stick figure drawings on some of the most important scenes in Henry IV Part 2.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 1-2 p.207-223 "By cock and pie," - "life one day."

- How would you describe Falstaff's relationship with Henry? Do you think Henry can remain friends with Falstaff?

WEEK 11

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 23

Materials: Henry IV Part 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 3 - Epilogue p.223-245 "Nay, you shall" - "bid you good night."

- Why does Henry say he doesn't know Falstaff?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students review the PBS infographic to help the students tie the narrative together.

∞ Link: Henry Part 2 Map

WEEK 12

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Henry IV Part 2

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RATIONALE

The Winter's Tale is a play divided into two halves: tragedy and redemption. Note the power of jealousy to destroy, but the greater power of love to restore.

→ INTRO

The Winter's Tale is not a traditional tragedy or comedy. It is often called a Tragicomedy because it has both comedic and tragic elements. Overall, the play has a happy ending which places it in the comedic category. Let's take some time to review the elements of tragedy and comedy.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scenes 1-2 p.7-25 "Archidamus, a Bohemian" - "an honest man."

- Why is Leontes suspicious of Hermione and Polixenes? What does this reveal about his character at the start of the play?

★ TEACHER TIP

Pre-Teaching Materials:

Movies Recommendations:

- The Winter's Tale BBC (1981)
- Branagh's The Winter's Tale (2015)

★ TEACHER TIP

Refresh yourself if desired on Shakespeare's plays and biography to share "by the way," especially the section on how Shakespeare structures his tragedies and comedies.

Remember to read the summaries before a scene to help orient students and explore retellings if desired.

∞ Link: Genres of Shakespeare

∞ Link: Course Hero

WEEK 2

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 26

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch Act 1, Scene 2, and get an understanding of the conflict of the play. King Leontes' jealousy is the basis for the conflict of the play. Shakespeare uses the word 'cuckholded' to describe adultery. To gain a deeper understanding, consult the Oxford dictionary.

∞ Video Link: Act 1, Scene 2

∞ Link: Cuckolded Definition

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 1 Scene 2 p.25-43 "Camillo, this great" - "Come, sir, away."

- How do Camillo's actions contrast with the kings'? What does this reveal about his character?

WEEK 3

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 2, Scene 1.

∞ Video Link: Act 2, Scene 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scenes 1-2 p.47-67 "Take the boy" - "betwixt you and danger."

- How does Leontes's treatment of Hermione affect those around him, especially Mamillius?

WEEK 4

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 28

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 2 Scene 3 p.67-83 "Nor night nor day" - "upon my bidding."

- What is internal conflict? How does internal conflict within Leontes lead to external conflicts?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students work on character quotes 1-3.

∞ Link: Character Quotes

WEEK 5

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading, let's watch a clip from Act 3, scene 2.

∞ Video Link: Act 3, Scene 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scenes 1-2 p.87-105 "The climate's delicate" - "To these sorrows."

- Act 3 is considered a turning point in the play. What changes do we see in Leontes, in other characters, or in the plot?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students work on character quotes 4-5.

∞ Link: Character Quotes

WEEK 6

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 30

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

In this scene, we will encounter a puzzling stage direction: "He exits, pursued by a bear." One

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students finish the character quotes if there are any remaining quotes. Afterwards, they can do the Royal Shakespeare Company's Create a Bear exercise.

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

question that interpreters ask is, did they use a real bear? At the time, chained-up bears were used as live entertainment. Many have speculated whether or not the Bard would have used an actual bear in a live performance. Since using live bears raises many safety and ethical concerns, artists have since found fun ways to enact this scene. If time permits, read the article from Folgers of the same title as the line to learn more.
∞ Article Link: Pursued by a bear

- ∞ **Link:** Character Quotes
- ∞ **Link:** Create a Bear

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 3 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 2 p.105-125 "Thou art perfect," - "disguise ourselves."

- Consider the role of fate in the play. Why is Antigonus killed but Perdita spared? Why do you think Perdita is being spared?

WEEK 7

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Let's watch a clip and see a 'fool' or a silly person who is mocked and made fun of.
∞ Video Link: Act 4, Scene 3

To accompany our reading today, we will do a fun and informative exercise, Act Like a Fool! In Shakespeare's day, audiences loved foolish characters. In The Winter's Tale, Autolycus is the play's fool. In Act Like a Fool, students will try to play the role in the most ridiculous and funny way they can.
∞ Link: Act Like a Fool

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 3 - Act 4 Scene 4 p.125-145 "When daffodils" - "Come, strike up."

- What role does Autolycus serve in the play? What type of fool do you think he is?

WEEK 8

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Act 4, Scene 4 is a challenging scene. One helpful framework to understand the scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Each main character has a secret that must be revealed. While reading, let's ask: What are those secrets? What needs to be revealed? If time permits, let's take a look at Exploring Act 4 in the Extra Helping.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.145-165 "Pray, good shepherd," - "to die when I desire."

- Contrast Perdita and Florizel's motives at the celebration with Polixenes and Camillo's motives at the celebration. How are they different?

• EXTRA HELPING

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

- ∞ **Link:** Exploring Act 4

WEEK 9

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Act 4, Scene 4 is a challenging scene. One helpful framework to understand the scene is [secret-reveal] or [deception-truth]. Each main character has a secret that must be revealed. While reading, let's ask: What are those secrets? What needs to be revealed? If time permits, let's take a look at Exploring Act 4 in the Extra Helping.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 4 Scene 4 p.165-191 "Why look you" - "be matter in it."

- Would you ever love someone if it brought conflict to your family or country? How do Florizel's values of love and duty seem to conflict in the scene?

★ Extra Helping

For more information, take a look at Exploring Act 4.

- ∞ **Link:** Exploring Act 4

WEEK 10

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 34

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ RECAP

How does the sheep-shearing festival go from a joyful celebration to a moment of crisis for Perdita and Florizel?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scene 1 p.195-213 "Sir, you have" - "good my lord."

- How has Leontes changed from the beginning of the play to this scene? What has caused his transformation?

Term 3

WEEK 11

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Winter's Tale

→ INTRO

Before reading the famous scene on Hermione's Statue, let's read an article on the scene and note the lines they cite. While reading, we should feel a sense of magic and enchantment in this scene.
∞ Article Link: Hermione's Statue

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Act 5 Scenes 2-3 p.213-235 "Beseech you, sir," - "Hastily lead away."

• How does the final scene tie together the themes of reconciliation and renewal? What characters experienced renewal?

• EXTRA HELPING

Have students play the review game The Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation.
∞ Link: Winter's Tale: Path to Reconciliation

Watch a clip of Aslan's breath. C.S. Lewis was an English professor and was very familiar with Shakespeare's works. There is an intriguing parallel between The Winter's Tale and The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe. Watch the scene, Aslan's breath, and see if the students can spot the parallel. Consider too how the breath of God is used in Scripture to create life (Gen. 2:7), resurrect the dead (Ezek. 37:9-10), and to impart the Holy Spirit (John 20:22).
∞ Video Link: Aslan's Breath

WEEK 12

30m Shakespeare: Grades 5-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Winter's Tale

Shakespeare: Grades 5-8

Examination

Term 1

- (GRADE 5-6) The Tempest: Describe your favorite scene or character from the story. Why did you like this particular scene/character? Provide details from the story in your response.
- (GRADE 5-6) The Tempest: (Optional) What lesson does Prospero learn by the end of the play, and how does it change his actions?
- (GRADE 7-8) The Tempest: Choose one and give as much detail as possible:
 - What lesson does Prospero learn by the end of the play, and how does it change his actions?
 - Is Caliban justified in his anger toward Prospero? What might motivate Caliban to plot against Prospero?
 - How does Prospero use magic to control the events on the island? Do you think he is fair in his use of magic? Why or why not?

Term 2

- (GRADE 5-6) Henry IV, Part 2: Describe your favorite scene or character from the story. Why did you like this particular scene/character? Provide details from the story in your response.
- (GRADE 5-6) Henry IV, Part 2: (Optional) What struggles does King Henry IV face in this play, and how do they affect his rule?
- (GRADE 7-8) Henry IV, Part 2: Choose one and give as much detail as possible:
 - What struggles does King Henry IV face in this play, and how do they affect his rule?
 - Do you think Prince Hal was ready to be King? Why or why not?
 - How does Prince Hal's relationship with Falstaff change by the end of the play? Why does he make this decision?

Term 3

- (GRADE 5-6) The Winter's Tale: Describe your favorite scene or character from the story. Why did you like this particular scene/character? Provide details from the story in your response.
- (GRADE 5-6) The Winter's Tale: What was a conflict or misunderstanding that was resolved in the play?
- (GRADE 7-8) The Winter's Tale: Choose one and give as much detail as possible:
 - Why does King Leontes wrongly accuse his wife, Hermione, and what are the consequences of his actions?
 - Is King Leontes a good man? Why or why not?
 - How does the story shift from tragedy to comedy? What events make this possible?